MODULE 2

Come to Your Senses

"All our knowledge begins with the senses."

— IMMANUEL KANT

ESSENTIAL QUESTION

How do people and animals use their senses to navigate the world?

MAIN SELECTIONS

1	**The Science Behind Sight** · Louise Spilsbury	INFORMATIONAL
2	**Animal Senses** · from Animal Atlas	INFORMATIONAL VIDEO
3	**Blind Ambition** · Matthew Cooper	PERSONAL NARRATIVE
4	**The Game of Silence** · Louise Erdrich	HISTORICAL FICTION

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A · Vocabulary (26) ..... p. 2

B · Reading Comprehension (32) ..... p. 6

C · IB Critical Thinking (5) ..... p. 12

D · MAP Practice (20) ..... p. 15

NAME _____ DATE _____

A Worksheet A — Vocabulary

Module 2 · Come to Your Senses · Grade 4 · 26 Items

CCSS L.4.4 · L.4.5 · L.4.6

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each question carefully. Watch out for tricky choices. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

BIG IDEA WORDS

Q1 L.4.6

perception

Your **perception** of something is —

- ◯ **A.** a drawing you make of it on paper.
- ◯ **B.** a fact about it that is always true for everyone.
- ◯ **C.** how you notice or experience it using your senses.
- ◯ **D.** the name that other people have given it.

Q2 L.4.5 TRAP

tactile

Something that is **tactile** is —

- ◯ **A.** experienced through the sense of touch.
- ◯ **B.** done quietly so no one can hear it.
- ◯ **C.** planned far ahead of time.
- ◯ **D.** able to be seen only in bright light.

Q3 L.4.6

aroma

An **aroma** is —

- ◯ **A.** a loud, sudden noise.
- ◯ **B.** a strong, pleasant smell.
- ◯ **C.** a bright flash of color.
- ◯ **D.** a rough, scratchy texture.

Q4 L.4.6

distinguish

If you **distinguish** two things, you —

- **A.** mix them together into one.
- **B.** hide them so no one can find them.
- **C.** trade one of them for the other.
- **D.** tell how they are different from each other.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE SCIENCE BEHIND SIGHT

Q5 L.4.4

luminous

The sun is **luminous**. If something is **luminous**, it —

- **A.** gives off light.
- **B.** floats on top of water.
- **C.** makes a loud sound.
- **D.** feels cold to the touch.

Q6 L.4.4

transparent

A clear window is **transparent**. If an object is **transparent**, you —

- **A.** can hear sounds through it clearly.
- **B.** can bend it without breaking it.
- **C.** can see through it.
- **D.** cannot lift it because it is heavy.

Q7 L.4.5 TRAP

reflect

A mirror makes light **reflect**. When light **reflects** off a surface, it —

- **A.** stops and disappears completely.
- **B.** bounces back without passing through the surface.
- **C.** thinks quietly about a problem.
- **D.** turns into heat right away.

Q8 L.4.4

illuminates

A lamp **illuminates** a dark room. Something that **illuminates** —

- ◯ **A.** cools the air around it.
- ◯ **B.** makes a space quieter.
- ◯ **C.** cleans the surface it touches.
- ◯ **D.** gives off light and makes the area around it brighter.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE SCIENCE BEHIND SIGHT (CONTINUED)

Q9 L.4.5 TRAP

judge

Using two eyes helps you **judge** how far away something is. In this sentence, to **judge** means to —

- ◯ **A.** guess or estimate the size or amount of something.
- ◯ **B.** decide who is guilty in a courtroom.
- ◯ **C.** say that someone has done wrong.
- ◯ **D.** hand out a prize at a contest.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · ANIMAL SENSES

Q10 L.4.5 TRAP

relish

Some animals **relish** a good meal. If you **relish** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** put it on a hot dog or burger.
- ◯ **B.** share it with everyone nearby.
- ◯ **C.** enjoy it very much.
- ◯ **D.** save it for another day.

Q11 L.4.4

familiar

An animal can recognize a **familiar** smell. Something **familiar** is something you —

- ◯ **A.** are afraid of.
- ◯ **B.** have never met before.
- ◯ **C.** can only find at night.
- ◯ **D.** know and are used to.

Q12 L.4.4

savor

An animal may **savor** its food. If you **savor** something, you —

- **A.** take your time enjoying it.
- **B.** swallow it as fast as you can.
- **C.** throw it away without tasting it.
- **D.** give it to someone else.

Q13 L.4.4

enhance

Sharp senses can **enhance** an animal's hunting. If you **enhance** something, you —

- **A.** hide it from view.
- **B.** make it better or improve it.
- **C.** count how many there are.
- **D.** break it into smaller pieces.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · BLIND AMBITION

Q14 L.4.4

accepted

Matthew has **accepted** that he is blind. If you have **accepted** a situation, you —

- **A.** are still trying to change it.
- **B.** have completely forgotten about it.
- **C.** understand that it cannot be changed.
- **D.** have never noticed it at all.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · BLIND AMBITION (CONTINUED)

Q15 L.4.4

obstacles

Twyla helps Matthew get around **obstacles**. **Obstacles** are —

- **A.** friends who walk beside you.
- **B.** sounds you hear in the street.
- **C.** directions that tell you where to go.
- **D.** objects that make it hard to get where you want to go.

Q16 L.4.5 TRAP

command

Twyla follows Matthew on **command**. If you do something on **command**, you do it —

- **A.** because you were told to.
- **B.** by yourself, with no one else.
- **C.** only when you feel like it.
- **D.** as a complete surprise.

Q17 L.4.4

denying

Matthew does not waste time **denying** the truth. **Denying** something means —

- **A.** explaining it to a friend.
- **B.** not believing that it is true.
- **C.** writing it down to remember it.
- **D.** asking someone for more of it.

Q18 L.4.4

adapt

To fit in, Matthew knows he has to **adapt**. If you **adapt** to something, you —

- **A.** refuse to deal with it.
- **B.** run away from it.
- **C.** figure out how to deal with it.
- **D.** wait for it to go away on its own.

Q19 L.4.4

comfort

A friend can **comfort** you when you are sad. If you **comfort** someone, you —

- **A.** leave them all alone.
- **B.** tell them they are wrong.
- **C.** make them feel worse.
- **D.** say or do things to make them feel better.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE GAME OF SILENCE

Q20 L.4.5 TRAP

absurd

Staying perfectly still felt **absurd** to Omakayas. Something **absurd** is —

- ◯ **A.** silly or ridiculous.
- ◯ **B.** sad and serious.
- ◯ **C.** hard and tiring.
- ◯ **D.** dark and quiet.

CRITICAL VOCABULARY · THE GAME OF SILENCE (CONTINUED)

Q21 L.4.4

taunt

Pinch tries to make his sister react with a **taunt**. A **taunt** is —

- ◯ **A.** a gift you give to a friend.
- ◯ **B.** something you say to anger or upset someone.
- ◯ **C.** a quiet song you hum to yourself.
- ◯ **D.** a question you ask to learn something.

Q22 L.4.4

forfeit

If she made a sound, Omakayas would **forfeit** the game. If you **forfeit** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** win it by trying hard.
- ◯ **B.** share it with a friend.
- ◯ **C.** lose it because you have broken a rule.
- ◯ **D.** hide it from everyone else.

Q23 L.4.5 TRAP

despised

Omakayas **despised** losing to her brother. If you **despised** something, you —

- ◯ **A.** felt unsure about it.
- ◯ **B.** were curious about it.
- ◯ **C.** wished to learn more about it.
- ◯ **D.** felt a strong dislike for it.

Q24 L.4.4

ferocious

Old Tallow's **ferocious** dogs stood guard. Something that is **ferocious** is —

- **A.** very fierce, mean, and violent.
- **B.** gentle and friendly.
- **C.** tired and sleepy.
- **D.** small and shy.

Q25 L.4.4

elaborately

Some gifts were **elaborately** decorated. If something is **elaborately** decorated, it has —

- **A.** no decoration at all.
- **B.** many complex, artistic details.
- **C.** a single plain color.
- **D.** a strong, unpleasant smell.

Q26 L.4.4

coveted

Pinch **coveted** the prize in the pile. If you **coveted** something, you —

- **A.** already owned it.
- **B.** gave it away to someone.
- **C.** wanted it very much.
- **D.** were afraid of it.

B Worksheet B — Reading Comprehension

Module 2 · Come to Your Senses · Grade 4 · 32 Items

CCSS RI.4.1 · RI.4.2 · RI.4.3 · RI.4.5 · RI.4.6 · RI.4.8 · RL.4.1 · RL.4.2 · RL.4.3

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you remember from each selection to answer the questions. Fill in the circle next to the BEST answer.

Selection 1 · The Science Behind Sight

INFORMATIONAL TEXT · LOUISE SPILSBURY · 8 QUESTIONS

Q1 RI.4.2

What is "The Science Behind Sight" mostly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to build a model of the solar system.
- ◯ **B.** How light and the eye work together so that people and animals can see.
- ◯ **C.** How to take care of a pet cat at night.
- ◯ **D.** Why the sun is hotter than other stars.

Q2 RI.4.1

According to the text, what makes an object *luminous*?

- ◯ **A.** It is very large and heavy.
- ◯ **B.** It can be seen through, like glass.
- ◯ **C.** It gives off its own light, like the sun.
- ◯ **D.** It bounces back the light that hits it.

Q3 RI.4.3

The text explains that we can see most objects around us because —

- ◯ **A.** light bounces, or reflects, off them and into our eyes.
- ◯ **B.** every object gives off its own light.
- ◯ **C.** our eyes shine light onto them.
- ◯ **D.** they are all transparent.

Q4 RI.4.3

How does the pupil of the eye change in bright light and in low light?

- **A.** It stays exactly the same size all the time.
- **B.** It gets bigger in bright light and smaller in low light.
- **C.** It changes color from black to blue.
- **D.** It gets smaller in bright light and bigger in low light.

Q5 RI.4.3

What happens to the image after a lens focuses it onto the retina?

- **A.** The image disappears before the brain can see it.
- **B.** The image is already perfectly upright and clear.
- **C.** The image arrives upside down, and the brain turns it the right way up.
- **D.** The image splits into many smaller pictures.

Q6 RI.4.8

The author states that having two eyes on the front of the head helps predators like foxes and lions. What reason does the text give to support this?

- **A.** It helps them judge distance so they can hunt and catch other animals.
- **B.** It lets them see colors more brightly.
- **C.** It keeps their eyes safe from the sun.
- **D.** It makes them look more frightening.

Q7 RI.4.3

Why do a cat's eyes glow in the dark, according to the text?

- **A.** Cats make their own light to scare away mice.
- **B.** A cat's eyes are filled with tiny light bulbs.
- **C.** Cats close their pupils tightly at night.
- **D.** A part behind the retina acts like a mirror and reflects light back onto the retina.

Q8 RI.4.5

This text uses headings, labeled diagrams, and captions. How do these text features help the reader?

- **A.** They turn the text into a made-up story.
- **B.** They organize the information and show how parts of the eye work.
- **C.** They hide the main facts until the end.
- **D.** They list the price of each tool.

Selection 2 · Animal Senses

INFORMATIONAL VIDEO · FROM ANIMAL ATLAS · 8 QUESTIONS

Q9 RI.4.2

What is the video "Animal Senses" mainly about?

- ◯ **A.** How to train a pet to do tricks.
- ◯ **B.** How zoos are built and cared for.
- ◯ **C.** How animals sleep through the winter.
- ◯ **D.** How different animals use their senses to find food and stay safe.

Q10 RI.4.6

In an informational video, who shares the main information with the audience?

- ◯ **A.** A character who is acting in a play.
- ◯ **B.** A narrator, who explains what is happening on the screen.
- ◯ **C.** The animals, who speak to one another.
- ◯ **D.** The people watching at home.

Q11 RI.4.6

The narrator says that "nature is the great compensator." What does the narrator mean by this?

- ◯ **A.** Nature makes up for one sense that is weak by making another sense stronger.
- ◯ **B.** Nature pays animals money for their work.
- ◯ **C.** All animals have exactly the same senses.
- ◯ **D.** Animals never need their senses to survive.

Q12 RI.4.3

The video explains that a rhinoceros does not have strong eyesight. Why is weak eyesight not a big problem for the rhinoceros?

- ◯ **A.** It can close its eyes and still run fast.
- ◯ **B.** It only comes out in the daytime.
- ◯ **C.** It has no natural predators, so sharp eyesight is not necessary.
- ◯ **D.** It uses its eyes to find water.

Q13 RI.4.3

According to the video, how do many animals use their sense of touch?

- ◯ **A.** To change the color of their fur.
- ◯ **B.** To find their way around their habitats.
- ◯ **C.** To talk to animals far away.
- ◯ **D.** To see clearly in the dark.

Q14 RI.4.2

How does an informational video like "Animal Senses" give information differently from a book of words alone?

- ◯ **A.** It can only show one animal at a time.
- ◯ **B.** It cannot teach any real facts.
- ◯ **C.** It must be read slowly, page by page.
- ◯ **D.** It uses a narrator together with moving pictures and sound to explain ideas.

Q15 RI.4.3

Based on the video, how can you tell whether an animal is a predator or a prey animal?

- ◯ **A.** By how the animal uses its senses to hunt prey or to escape predators.
- ◯ **B.** By how loud the animal can be.
- ◯ **C.** By the color of the animal's eyes.
- ◯ **D.** By how many hours the animal sleeps.

Q16 RI.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN idea of "Animal Senses"?

- ◯ **A.** A rhinoceros has weak eyesight.
- ◯ **B.** Some animals hunt at night.
- ◯ **C.** Animals depend on their senses, each in its own way, to survive in the world.
- ◯ **D.** A narrator speaks during the video.

Selection 3 · Blind Ambition

PERSONAL NARRATIVE · MATTHEW COOPER, AS TOLD TO RACHEL BUCHHOLZ · 8 QUESTIONS

Q17 RI.4.2

What is "Blind Ambition" mostly about?

- **A.** How to choose the best dog at a shelter.
- **B.** The rules of the game of paintball.
- **C.** A blind boy named Matthew who adapts and uses his other senses, with help from his guide dog, to do the things he loves.
- **D.** How eye doctors test people's vision.

Q18 RI.4.3

Why did Matthew lose his sight?

- **A.** At age three he was diagnosed with a brain tumor that pressed against his optic nerve.
- **B.** He was hurt while playing a sport.
- **C.** He stared at the sun for too long.
- **D.** He was born without any eyes.

Q19 RI.4.3

How does Twyla, Matthew's guide dog, help him?

- **A.** She reads his schoolbooks out loud to him.
- **B.** She plays golf and paintball with him.
- **C.** She tells him jokes to make him laugh.
- **D.** She helps him cross streets, get around obstacles, and walk through crowded school hallways.

Q20 RI.4.3

How does Matthew adapt so he can play paintball and run the sound system for his school plays?

- **A.** He asks other people to do these things for him.
- **B.** He has his friends wear buzzers so he knows where they are, and he puts Braille labels on the controls.
- **C.** He decides not to do them at all.
- **D.** He waits until he can see again.

Q21 RI.4.6

"Blind Ambition" is told by Matthew using the word "I." How does this first-person point of view help the reader?

- **A.** It keeps Matthew's feelings hidden from the reader.
- **B.** It tells the story from Twyla's point of view.
- **C.** It makes the events seem made up.
- **D.** It lets the reader hear Matthew's own thoughts and feelings about his life from the inside.

Q22 RI.4.3

When Matthew plays golf, how does he know where to aim?

- **A.** His coach or his dad positions his club behind the ball and tells him how far away the hole is.
- **B.** He listens for the sound of the hole.
- **C.** Twyla leads him to the right spot.
- **D.** He uses a special pair of glasses.

Q23 RI.4.8

Matthew says, "I think being blind makes me a better golfer." Which idea from the selection BEST supports this surprising claim?

- **A.** He thinks golf is an easy game.
- **B.** He believes "there's always something life takes from you, and something life gives back."
- **C.** He has never lost a golf match.
- **D.** He plans to stop playing golf soon.

Q24 RI.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN message, or central idea, of "Blind Ambition"?

- **A.** Matthew got Twyla about a year and a half ago.
- **B.** Matthew runs the sound system for school plays.
- **C.** By accepting his situation and adapting, a person can use other senses and help to live a full, capable life.
- **D.** Matthew reads Braille and tells jokes.

Selection 4 · The Game of Silence

HISTORICAL FICTION · LOUISE ERDRICH / PAOLO DOMENICONI · 8 QUESTIONS

Q25 RL.4.2

What is "The Game of Silence" mostly about?

- **A.** How to build a birchbark canoe.
- **B.** A long journey across the ocean.
- **C.** An Ojibwe girl, Omakayas, who struggles to stay silent in a game while the adults prepare to discuss serious news.
- **D.** A contest to catch the most fish.

Q26 RL.4.3

How does Pinch try to make Omakayas lose the game of silence?

- **A.** He shouts in her ear as loudly as he can.
- **B.** He hides all of her food.
- **C.** He tells the grandmother on her.
- **D.** He teases her, steals her doll, and lays a burning wand next to her ankle.

Q27 RL.4.3

How does Omakayas get her beloved doll back from Pinch?

- **A.** She pretends to shut her eyes, then snatches it back at just the right moment.
- **B.** She asks Nokomis to take it from him.
- **C.** She trades a prize for it.
- **D.** She cries until he gives it back.

Q28 RL.4.3

Why are the children playing the game of silence in the first place?

- **A.** They are practicing for a school play.
- **B.** They must stay quiet so the adults can talk about what is happening to their people.
- **C.** They are trying to fall asleep.
- **D.** They want to win a swimming race.

Q29 RL.4.3

How does the mood at the gathering change by the end of the story?

- **A.** The children decide never to play again.
- **B.** The playful game turns serious as everyone realizes the bigger loss they face is the loss of their home.
- **C.** Everyone leaves angry at Pinch.
- **D.** A storm forces them all indoors.

Q30 RL.4.3

The author writes that Nokomis "creaked like a tree every time she moved." What does this comparison help the reader understand?

- **A.** Nokomis is climbing a tall tree.
- **B.** Nokomis is made of wood.
- **C.** Nokomis is afraid of the forest.
- **D.** Nokomis is very old, and her bones ache when she moves.

Q31 RL.4.3

Why does staying silent become harder and harder for Omakayas as the story goes on?

- **A.** Pinch keeps teasing her, so she must hold back her anger to keep from crying out.
- **B.** The room grows colder and colder.
- **C.** She becomes very sleepy.
- **D.** The other children keep asking her questions.

Q32 RL.4.2 TRAP

What is the MAIN theme, or message, of "The Game of Silence"?

- **A.** Pinch placed a burning wand by Omakayas's ankle.
- **B.** Old Tallow arrived smelling of wolf.
- **C.** Silence and careful attention can help us understand what matters most, such as the value of home.
- **D.** Nokomis sang the song of the game four times.

Worksheet C — IB Critical Thinking

Module 2 · Come to Your Senses · Grade 4

IB PYP Key Concepts · DOK 2 – 4

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Use what you learned from each selection to think more deeply about how people and animals use their senses to navigate the world. Each question helps you grow as an IB learner.

Q1 Function DOK 3

In **"The Science Behind Sight,"** seeing happens in a chain of steps. Show how light travels so that we can see, then explain WHY each part of the eye matters.

HOW SIGHT WORKS · THE SCIENCE BEHIND SIGHT

LIGHT STARTS	INTO THE EYE	TO THE BRAIN

Why do we see most objects even though they are not luminous? Use the word *reflect* in your answer.

Q2 Perspective DOK 3

In **"Animal Senses,"** different animals depend on different senses. Trace THREE ways animals use their senses, then explain what "nature is the great compensator" means.

HOW ANIMALS USE THEIR SENSES · ANIMAL SENSES

SENSE 1 · SIGHT OR HEARING

how does it help find food or prey?

SENSE 2 · SMELL

how does it help an animal stay safe?

SENSE 3 · TOUCH

how does it help in the habitat?

What does the narrator mean by "nature is the great compensator"? Use the rhinoceros as an example.

Q3 Responsibility DOK 3

In **"Blind Ambition,"** Matthew ACCEPTS his situation and ADAPTS. Show what he cannot do with sight, and how he uses other senses and help to do it anyway.

ACCEPT AND ADAPT · BLIND AMBITION

THE CHALLENGE	HOW MATTHEW ADAPTS

Matthew says, "I think being blind makes me a better golfer." What does this show about how he chooses to see his life?

Q4 Causation DOK 3

In **"The Game of Silence,"** a playful game slowly turns serious. Compare what the game is like at the START with what it MEANS by the END.

FROM PLAY TO UNDERSTANDING · THE GAME OF SILENCE

THE GAME AT THE START	WHAT SILENCE MEANS BY THE END

How does staying silent and paying close attention help the children understand the serious news about their home? Explain.

Q5 Connection DOK 4

Essential Question: How do people and animals use their senses to navigate the world? Use ideas from TWO of the selections in this module to answer.

TWO-SELECTION SYNTHESIS

SELECTION 1 · TITLE

Who uses the senses here, which senses, and how do they help them navigate the world?

SELECTION 2 · TITLE

Who uses the senses here, which senses, and how do they help them navigate the world?

MY BIG IDEA

Worksheet D — MAP Practice

Module 2 · Come to Your Senses · Grade 4

MAP RIT 200 → 220 · 4 Mini-Passages × 5 Questions

NAME _____ DATE _____

Directions. Read each short passage carefully. Then answer the 5 questions that follow. Each passage is NEW — not from the selections in this workbook.

Passage 1 · The Owl's Night Eyes

Owls are some of the best night hunters in the world. While other animals sleep, an owl glides through the dark forest searching for food. Owls can do this because their eyes are very special. An owl's eyes are huge for the size of its head. Big eyes can take in more light, so even a little moonlight is enough for an owl to see. Unlike a person's eyes, an owl's eyes cannot move from side to side. To look around, an owl must turn its whole head. An owl can turn its head almost all the way around, which helps it watch for mice and other small animals. An owl also has sharp hearing. Its ears can find the soft sound of a mouse moving under leaves, even when the owl cannot see it. By using both its eyes and its ears, an owl can hunt in the dark when most other animals cannot. Its body is built perfectly for a life spent awake at night.

167 WORDS · LEXILE 500–560L · RIT 200–206

Q1 RIT 200 | Lexile 500L | Key Detail

When do owls hunt for food?

- ◯ **A.** At night, in the dark.
- ◯ **B.** Only in the middle of the day.
- ◯ **C.** Just after they wake up at noon.
- ◯ **D.** Only during a storm.

Q2 RIT 202 | Lexile 520L | Cause & Effect

Why can an owl see when there is only a little moonlight?

- ◯ **A.** It makes its own light.
- ◯ **B.** Its big eyes can take in more light.
- ◯ **C.** It closes its eyes and listens only.
- ◯ **D.** It flies above the clouds.

Q3 RIT 203 · Lexile 530L · Key Detail

Why must an owl turn its whole head to look around?

- ◯ **A.** Its head is too heavy to hold still.
- ◯ **B.** It is trying to scare away other animals.
- ◯ **C.** Its eyes cannot move from side to side.
- ◯ **D.** It wants to hear better.

Q4 RIT 205 · Lexile 550L · Inference

The passage says an owl can find a mouse "even when the owl cannot see it." This suggests that —

- ◯ **A.** the owl is not really hunting.
- ◯ **B.** the mouse is glowing in the dark.
- ◯ **C.** the owl gives up when it is dark.
- ◯ **D.** the owl can rely on its hearing when its eyes are not enough.

Q5 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Owl's Night Eyes"?

- ◯ **A.** An owl's senses are built to help it hunt in the dark.
- ◯ **B.** Owls are afraid of mice.
- ◯ **C.** All birds can see in the dark.
- ◯ **D.** Owls have the smallest eyes of any animal.

Passage 2 · How Dogs Smell the World

People learn about the world mostly by seeing it, but dogs learn about the world mostly by smelling it. A dog's nose is far more powerful than a human nose. While a person has about five million tiny smell sensors inside the nose, a dog can have more than two hundred million. This means a dog can notice smells that are much too faint for a person to detect. To a dog, a single sniff is full of information. By smelling a tree, a dog might learn which animals passed by, how long ago they came, and even whether they were healthy or afraid. Dogs also use their noses to find things people cannot. Some dogs are trained to sniff out lost hikers, while others can smell when a person is sick. A dog will often stop on a walk to smell one spot for a long time. It is not being slow or stubborn. It is simply reading the world the way it knows best, through its remarkable sense of smell.

172 WORDS · LEXILE 560–620L · RIT 206–211

Q6 RIT 206 · Lexile 560L · Key Detail

How do dogs learn about the world mostly?

- ◯ **A.** By seeing it.
- ◯ **B.** By smelling it.
- ◯ **C.** By tasting it.
- ◯ **D.** By listening to it.

Q7 RIT 208 | Lexile 580L | Key Detail

About how many smell sensors can a dog have inside its nose?

- ◯ **A.** About five million.
- ◯ **B.** About one thousand.
- ◯ **C.** More than two hundred million.
- ◯ **D.** Exactly one hundred.

Q8 RIT 209 | Lexile 590L | Cause & Effect

Why can a dog notice smells that a person cannot?

- ◯ **A.** A dog walks much more slowly.
- ◯ **B.** A dog has a longer nose to look through.
- ◯ **C.** A dog only smells things outdoors.
- ◯ **D.** A dog has far more smell sensors, so it can detect very faint smells.

Q9 RIT 210 | Lexile 600L | Inference

When a dog stops to smell one spot for a long time, the passage suggests that the dog is —

- ◯ **A.** gathering information about what happened there.
- ◯ **B.** being lazy and stubborn.
- ◯ **C.** too tired to keep walking.
- ◯ **D.** lost and confused.

Q10 RIT 211 | Lexile 620L | Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "How Dogs Smell the World"?

- ◯ **A.** Dogs are faster than people.
- ◯ **B.** A dog's powerful sense of smell is how it understands the world.
- ◯ **C.** All dogs should be trained to find hikers.
- ◯ **D.** People should never take dogs on walks.

Passage 3 · Reading with Your Fingers

Long ago, people who could not see had very few ways to read a book. Most books were made only of printed letters, which a blind person had no way to feel. Then, almost two hundred years ago, a French boy named Louis Braille changed everything. Louis had lost his sight in an accident when he was very young. As he grew up, he wished he could read the way other students did. When he was a teenager, Louis invented a clever system of raised dots that can be felt with the fingertips. Each small pattern of dots stands for a letter, a number, or even a musical note. Today this system is called braille, after the boy who created it. By moving their fingers gently across the rows of bumps, blind readers can enjoy whole books, write letters, and study any subject they choose. Braille turns the sense of touch into a doorway to reading. Because of one determined boy, millions of people who cannot see are still able to read.

172 WORDS · LEXILE 620–700L · RIT 211–216

Q11 RIT 211 · Lexile 620L · Key Detail

Who invented the system of raised dots for reading?

- **A.** A teacher from England.
- **B.** A doctor who studied eyes.
- **C.** A French boy named Louis Braille.
- **D.** A printer who made books.

Q12 RIT 212 · Lexile 640L · Cause & Effect

Why did Louis want to create a new way to read?

- **A.** He had lost his sight and wished he could read like other students.
- **B.** He did not like the books in his school.
- **C.** He wanted to become famous and rich.
- **D.** His teacher told him he had to.

Q13 RIT 213 · Lexile 660L · Key Detail

What can each small pattern of dots stand for?

- **A.** A color or a shape.
- **B.** A letter, a number, or a musical note.
- **C.** A whole sentence.
- **D.** A smell or a taste.

Q14 RIT 215 · Lexile 680L · Vocabulary

The passage says braille "turns the sense of touch into a doorway to reading." A **doorway** here means —

- **A.** a wooden door in a house.
- **B.** a way to reach or get to something.
- **C.** a kind of bookshelf.
- **D.** a heavy lock and key.

Q15 RIT 216 · Lexile 700L · Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "Reading with Your Fingers"?

- **A.** Old books were very hard to make.
- **B.** French is the best language for reading.
- **C.** Most students do not like to read.
- **D.** Braille lets the sense of touch open up reading for people who cannot see.

Passage 4 · The Taste Test

Mr. Alvarez told his class they were going to be scientists for the day. He set a small cup of juice and a soft blindfold on each desk. "Today," he said, "we will find out how much our senses work together." First, the students closed their noses with a clip and took a sip of the juice. To their surprise, the juice tasted dull and plain. They could barely tell what flavor it was. Then Mr. Alvarez told them to take off the clips and sip again. Suddenly the juice burst with the bright taste of orange. The students were amazed that the same juice could seem so different. Mr. Alvarez explained that taste and smell are partners. Much of what we think we taste actually comes from what we smell at the same time. That is why food seems flavorless when you have a stuffy nose from a cold. The class learned that our senses do not work alone. They team up to help us understand the world, and together they tell us far more than any single sense could on its own.

184 WORDS · LEXILE 700–800L · RIT 216–220

Q16 RIT 216 Lexile 700L Key Detail

What did Mr. Alvarez put on each student's desk?

- **A.** A cup of juice and a soft blindfold.
- **B.** A plate of cookies.
- **C.** A bowl of soup.
- **D.** A box of crayons.

Q17 RIT 217 Lexile 720L Cause & Effect

Why did the juice taste dull and plain at first?

- **A.** The juice was too cold.
- **B.** The students had clips on their noses, so they could not smell it.
- **C.** The juice was very old.
- **D.** The students had just eaten lunch.

Q18 RIT 218 Lexile 740L Key Detail

According to Mr. Alvarez, which two senses are "partners"?

- **A.** Sight and hearing.
- **B.** Touch and hearing.
- **C.** Taste and smell.
- **D.** Sight and touch.

Q19 RIT 219 Lexile 770L Inference

Based on the passage, why does food seem flavorless when you have a cold?

- ◯ **A.** A cold makes food taste salty.
- ◯ **B.** You eat more slowly when you are sick.
- ◯ **C.** Cold food has no flavor at all.
- ◯ **D.** A stuffy nose blocks your sense of smell, which is a big part of taste.

Q20 RIT 220 Lexile 800L Main Idea

What is the BIG IDEA of "The Taste Test"?

- ◯ **A.** Orange juice is the best drink.
- ◯ **B.** Science class is always fun.
- ◯ **C.** Blindfolds help you taste better.
- ◯ **D.** Our senses work together, and combined they tell us more than any one sense alone.